times faster than its population. While 59 percent of the city's territory is conservation land, illegal logging and urban sprawl continue to degrade urban forest, grassland, and water supplies.

It is estimated that 37 percent of all urban growth by 2050 will occur in China, India, and Nigeria alone. In Beijing and other cities in China, densely populated *hutongs* (alleyways), where the urban poor used to live, are being demolished to make way for low-density luxury blocks, pushing the city limits—and the urban poor—far from city centers. The reliance on cars in the new neighborhoods, and the lack of central hubs, means there is little opportunity for community life.

Aware of the problems caused by urbanization, the Chinese government is now trying to limit the population of Shanghai to 25 million and that of Beijing to 23 million by restricting land available for building and controlling the inflow of people, forcing out low-skilled workers. China is also building higher-density neighborhoods with narrower streets, more intersections, and more public transport that will help the formation of communities.